> great city, Tagara. There are brought down from these places by wagons and through great tracts without roads, from Paethana carnelian in great quantity, and from Tagara much common cloth, all kinds of muslins and mallow cloth, and other merchandise brought there from the regions along the sea coast.[2]

In 1901 the archaeologist Henry Cousens visited the town of Ter in the Osmanabad District of Maharashtra to check if it might indeed be the ancient Tagara. His findings led him to believe that it was – since confirmed by modern excavations and some exceptional finds such as the Ter 'Lakshmi' ivory figurine mentioned earlier. However, Cousens' outstanding discovery lay in recognising that a tiny Vaishnava shrine outside the town was actually a rare surviving example of an early Buddhist *chaitya-griha* from perhaps as early as the fourth century, built of brick but itself modelled on an earlier wooden temple (see illustration). These same little apsidal temples almost certainly provided the models for the group of Hindu temples carved out of the rocks at Mahabalipuram in the seventh century. Although misleadingly known as *ratha*s, after the chariots that carried deities in procession during temple festivities, these structures in turn served as templates for the classical Pallavan style of temple building in South India.

Also mentioned in the *Periplus* are two important ports on the west coast named 'Calliena' and 'Suppara', which had apparently become so silted up that shipping had had to be diverted elsewhere. Calliena was identified without difficulty as the modern town of Kalyan, now part of Greater Bombay. Suppara proved more elusive, until Bhagwan Lal Indraji was asked in 1882 to examine some inscribed stone fragments at modern Sopara, north of Bombay. He instantly recognised them as the remains of one of Emperor Ashoka's major rock edicts. He stayed on to excavate a mound outside Sopara